WEEKLY TRADING PERFORMANCE REPORT

Analysis Period:	August 5-7, 2026 (3 trading days)
Report Generated:	August 8, 2026
Trader:	James
Accounts:	LIVE options (Schwab) + Futures
Strategies:	SPX Bull Put Spreads (0DTE) | /MES + /ES futures scalping
Market:	Best week since April. S&P +3.58% to record close 7,757.64. First-ever close above 7,700 on Aug 5. July payrolls FELL 23k
Themes:	(1) Three deliberate first-hour entries — all won. (2) A repeatable template emerged. (3) Futures: the 30-minute line.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overall Performance: Options +$1,075 gross across 4 trades (100% win rate), +$980.68 net of $94.32 in fees and commissions. Futures -$50 across 2 trades (1 win, 1 loss). Combined: +$1,025 gross. Live options cumulative now +$2,750 across 65 trades; futures cumulative -$215 across 15.

Three of the four options trades were entered inside the first hour — against the standing guideline — and all three won. James flagged every one himself in the Mistakes column. That self-honesty is what makes the week analysable rather than simply celebratory, because the outcomes alone would teach exactly the wrong lesson. The detail that matters is buried in trade 217: the one first-hour entry taken *without* a resolved catalyst or a documented read got punished immediately and required a defensive exit that netted $1.42 after costs. The guideline still has teeth.

Key Findings:

- ★ A repeatable template emerged: $0.80 credit, 20-wide, 5 lots, OCO target $0.10. Run three days consecutively (218, 219, 220), it produced 88% capture and +$350 each time.
- ★ FUTURES — THE 30-MINUTE LINE: across all 15 futures trades, those held ≤30 minutes are 8W-3L for +$2,817.50. Those held >30 minutes are 1W-3L for -$3,032.50. The entire futures loss sits in long holds. Pattern survives excluding the FOMC trade.
- Three first-hour entries, three wins — but they are not the same trade. Two had resolved catalysts or documented reads; one (217) did not and was immediately punished. Taxonomy proposed below.
- Trade 217→218 is the week's cleanest lesson: the defensive exit, then patient re-entry at the SAME strikes for a HIGHER credit ($0.80 vs $0.65). Patience beat urgency on both price and outcome.
- Fee drag quantified: $94.32 on $1,525 premium collected = 6.2%, above the Rule 9 gate of 2%. Structural at this premium level, not a discipline failure. Flagged for review.
- F15 journal note — “1 ES = identical $50/pt exposure to the 10 micros in F14, same notional, different wrapper” — shows the FR2 notional framing is landing.

P&L; SUMMARY

Book	Trades	Wins	Losses	Win %	P&L
Options — SPX BPS (gross)	4	4	0	100%	+$1,075
Less: fees & commissions	—	—	—	—	-$94.32
Options — net	4	4	0	100%	+$980.68
Futures — /MES + /ES	2	1	1	50%	-$50
COMBINED (gross)	**6**	**5**	**1**	**83.3%**	**+$1,025**

CUMULATIVE TRACKING

Period	Options Trades	Options P&L	Options Cum.	Futures P&L	Futures Cum
Study Period (Jun 29-Aug 4)	14	+$2,370	+$1,675	-$165	-$165

Period	Options Trades	Options P&L	Options Cum.	Futures P&L	Futures Cum
This Week (Aug 5-7)	4	+$1,075	+$2,750	-$50	-$215

Cumulative figures are gross of fees, consistent with prior reports. This week's fee drag is quantified separately below. Live options: 65 trades since inception. Futures: 15 trades since July 24.

OPTIONS TRADES

#	Date	Strikes	Cts	Entry	Exit	Entry ET	P&L	Cap.	Notes
217	05/08	7670/7650	5	$0.65	$0.60	09:50	+$25	8%	First-hour, no read. Defensive exit.
218	05/08	7670/7650	5	$0.80	$0.10	~10:10	+$350	88%	Re-entry, higher credit. OCO.
219	06/08	7660/7640	5	$0.80	$0.10	09:46	+$350	88%	First-hour, documented read. OCO.
220	07/08	7655/7635	5	$0.80	$0.10	09:31	+$350	88%	Post-jobs-print. Catalyst resolved.

Amber: trade 217, the first-hour entry without a resolved catalyst or documented read.

THE FIRST-HOUR QUESTION

Three of four trades breached guideline G3 (no new entries in the first hour after a major data release / at the open). All three won. This is precisely the situation where outcome bias does its damage, so the analysis has to look past the P&L; column.

The three entries were not the same trade:

Trade	Entry (ET)	Catalyst State	Read Documented?	Result
217	09:50	None pending — but no read either. Morning weakness, direction unknown.	No	Went against immediately. Defensive exit +$25 gross, **+$1.42 net**.
219	09:46	No catalyst. Normal session.	Yes — ES range-bound, VIX 15.1 and falling 4.2%	Held green throughout. Theta outpaced a 13.6pt drift. 88% capture.
220	09:31	Jobs print released 08:30 ET — **binary already resolved**. Payrolls fell 23k, Sept hike off table, market rallying.	Yes — direction established pre-entry	Ran to a record close. OCO filled in 99 min. 88% capture.

What this suggests:

G3 exists because the tape is unreliable *while a print is being absorbed* — direction is unformed and premium is mispriced in both directions. That rationale applies fully to trade 217 (entered into unformed morning weakness with no read) and it duly punished the entry. It applies weakly to 219 (no catalyst at all, conditions documented and favourable) and arguably not at all to 220, where the binary had already resolved 61 minutes before entry — the same structural logic as trade 167 (post-PPI) and the IV crush [implied volatility compression after catalyst resolution] work from June.

Proposed refinement to G3 (for consideration, not adoption this week): the guideline should key on *catalyst state and read quality*, not clock time. Something closer to: “No entry while a catalyst is unresolved or direction is unformed, regardless of hour. Post-resolution entries with a documented read are permitted at any time.” That preserves what the rule is actually protecting against while removing the friction on trades like 220 that are structurally sound.

The honest caveat: this is three trades. Three wins in a bull week that closed at record highs is not evidence that first-hour entries are safe — it is evidence that these three were survivable. The refinement above should be logged as a hypothesis and tested, not adopted on a 3-trade sample. Continue flagging first-hour entries in the Mistakes column exactly as you have been.

THE EMERGING TEMPLATE

Trades 218, 219 and 220 are effectively the same trade run three days consecutively:

Parameter	Value	Rule Check
Structure	SPX 20-wide bull put spread, 0DTE	—
Credit	$0.80	Rule 21 floor $0.60 — PASS with headroom
Credit / width	4.0%	Rule 18 gate 20%... see note below
Contracts	5	Rule 6 reserve intact
Max risk	$9,600	~19% of account
Exit	OCO limit at $0.10	Mechanical — no live decision required
Result (x3)	88% capture, +$350 each	3 for 3

Note on Rule 18: a $0.80 credit on a 20-wide spread is 4% of width, well under the 20% gate as literally written. Rule 18 was authored for narrow spreads on single names (Trade 99's $2-wide) where width and strike distance are tightly coupled. On 20-wide SPX 0DTE with the short strike placed several standard deviations out, the binding constraint is Rule 21's absolute credit floor and the 4× stop headroom it buys — not the width ratio. **Rule 18 should be re-scoped to exclude wide index spreads, or the two rules will keep conflicting.** Worth resolving in the framework document rather than leaving as an implicit exception.

The wider point: mechanised exits are doing the work. All three closed on the OCO [one-cancels-other] limit at $0.10 with no discretionary decision at the back end. This is the structural answer to the freeze response — not willpower, but an order that fires without you.

TRADES 217 → 218: PATIENCE BEAT URGENCY

The sequence deserves its own note because it is the same strikes, the same day, twenty minutes apart, with a materially better outcome on the second attempt.

	Trade 217	Trade 218
Entry time (ET)	09:50	~10:10
Strikes	7670/7650	7670/7650 (identical)
Credit	$0.65	$0.80
Context at entry	Morning weakness, bottom not established	Bottom held, structure confirmed
Outcome	Went against; defensive exit	OCO filled at $0.10 after ~100 min
P&L (gross)	+$25	+$350
P&L (net of costs)	+$1.42	+$326.42

Twenty minutes of patience was worth $0.15 of extra credit and the difference between a scratch and an 88% capture. The defensive exit on 217 was correct — the endowment test was applied ("would I enter this now?"), the answer was no, the position was closed. But note what the net column shows: **after fees, trade 217 made $1.42.** A correctly-executed defensive exit on a 5-lot position barely clears its own transaction costs. That is not an argument against the exit — it is an argument for not needing it, which is what the read discipline on 219 and 220 delivered.

FEE DRAG: A STRUCTURAL OBSERVATION

Metric	Value
Premium collected (4 trades)	$1,525
Fees + commissions	$94.32
Fees as % of premium collected	6.2%

Metric	Value
Fees as % of gross P&L	8.8%
Rule 9 gate	Commissions under 2% of premium

At roughly $4.72 per contract round-trip, hitting Rule 9's 2% gate requires around $2.36 of credit per contract. On 20-wide SPX 0DTE spreads placed at safe strike distances, that credit level is not reachable — the strategy operates structurally at 5-7% fee drag.

This is **not** a discipline failure and the trades were correct. It is a rule-scope problem, the same one Rule 18 has: Rule 9 was written in a single-name, higher-premium context. Two things follow. First, Rule 9 needs an explicit SPX 0DTE threshold (something in the 8-10% range would be a real constraint rather than an unmeetable one). Second, and more usefully: **fee drag scales with contracts but not with credit**, so the ratio improves only by collecting more premium per contract, never by trading larger. That is a genuine argument for premium selectivity — a $1.20 entry carries half the proportional drag of a $0.60 entry for identical fees.

FUTURES: THE 30-MINUTE LINE

Two futures trades this week (F14, F15) for -$50 net. Both P&L; figures verified against points × $/point × contracts. But the more valuable finding comes from segmenting all 15 futures trades by holding time.

Holding Time	Trades	Wins	Losses	Win %	Total P&L	Avg P&L
≤30 minutes	11	8	3	72.7%	+$2,817.50	+$256
>30 minutes	4	1	3	25.0%	-$3,032.50	-$758
ALL	**15**	**9**	**6**	**60.0%**	**-$215**	**-$14**

Every losing dollar in the futures book sits in trades held longer than 30 minutes. The four long holds are F5 (105 min, +$30), F8 (34 min, -$475), F11 (46 min, -$2,025) and F14 (113 min, -$562.50). Strip out F11 — the FOMC breach, which had its own distinct cause — and the remaining three long holds are still -$1,007.50 on 1 win and 2 losses. The pattern is not an artefact of the one bad trade.

Why it likely holds:

- The winning trades are scalps against short-term order flow — an edge that exists for minutes, not hours. F6 (+$612.50 in 16 min), F13 (+$787.50 in 27 min), F15 (+$512.50 in 27 min).
- Once a scalp is held past its edge horizon, the position is no longer expressing the original read. It has quietly become a directional swing trade without a swing-trade thesis, stop, or size.
- F14 is the clean illustration: long 10 micros, faded 11.25 points, chain-linked bracket stop finally fired after 113 minutes. The bracket worked; the holding period was the problem.

Proposed FR5 — time stop: any futures scalp not working within 30 minutes is closed at market, irrespective of the price stop. The bracket stop protects against magnitude; a time stop protects against thesis decay. On this sample it would have converted -$3,032.50 of realised losses into something materially smaller.

Caveat, stated plainly: 15 trades is a small sample and 4 observations above the line is very thin. This is a hypothesis with a plausible mechanism, not a proven edge. Log it, apply it provisionally at current size, and re-test at 40+ trades before treating it as settled.

THIS WEEK'S FUTURES TRADES

#	Date	Contract	Dir	Cts	Pts	P&L	Mins	Notes
F14	05/08	/MES	Long	10	-11.25	-$562.50	113	Faded. Bracket fired after 113 min. 3rd-largest futures loss.
F15	07/08	/ES	Long	1	+10.25	+$512.50	27	Bracket target filled. Same notional as F14, different wrapper.

The F15 note is the week's best piece of self-observation. James recorded: “1 ES = identical $50/pt exposure to the 10 micros in F14 — same notional, different wrapper.” That is exactly the FR2 framing, arrived at independently and applied in real time. The instrument label changed; the risk did not, and it was recognised as such. This is what the futures rulebook is supposed to install.

MARKET CONTEXT

Wednesday 5 Aug: Recovery from the previous session's late 70-point drop. Morning weakness gave way once the bottom held; SPX closed around 7,723 — the first-ever close above 7,700. This is the session where trade 217's early entry caught the weakness and 218's re-entry caught the recovery.

Thursday 6 Aug: A pause after the record. SPX eased 0.18% to 7,709.96, fading from an intraday high. Mixed earnings and Strait of Hormuz uncertainty. VIX 15.1 and falling 4.2% — the falling-VIX read that justified trade 219's early entry. SPX drifted 13.6 points lower across the session but slowly enough that theta [time decay] outpaced the drift and the position stayed green throughout.

Friday 7 Aug: July payrolls contracted by 23,000 against expectations of an 80-83k gain, with May and June revised down by a combined 103,000. Unemployment ticked down to 4.1%, though largely because participation fell to 61.4% — a five-year low. Markets read weak jobs as removing the September hike: S&P; +0.62% to a record close of 7,757.64, Nasdaq +1.30% to

26,690.62, Dow +151.83 to 54,036.93. For the week, S&P; +3.58%, Nasdaq +5.19%, Dow +2.96% — the best week since April. SOXX finished the week up over 7% on the semiconductor bounce-back.

Relevance to the book: a rising, low-volatility, record-setting week is close to the ideal environment for bull put spreads. Three identical 88% captures in that regime should be read as the strategy working in favourable conditions — not as evidence that entry timing has been solved. The June bearish stretch is the honest comparison point for what the same template does when the tape turns.

FRAMEWORK COMPLIANCE

Rule	Status	Notes
R21: Min credit floor $0.60	PASS	All four at $0.65-$0.80. Three at $0.80 with headroom.
R20: Close 0DTE by 3:30pm ET	PASS	All closed intraday via OCO or manual exit.
R19: No binary catalysts	PASS	Trade 220 entered AFTER the 08:30 jobs print resolved. Correct application.
R12: Bounce = Exit / endowment test	PASS ✔	Trade 217 defensive exit. Test applied, position closed, no freeze.
R22: Verify position flat	PASS	No ghost trades.
R6: 20% BP reserve	PASS	5 lots, ~19% max risk per position.
G3: No first-hour entries	BREACHED ×3	217, 219, 220. All self-flagged. See analysis — refinement proposed, not adopted.
R9: Commissions under 2% of premium	BREACHED	6.2%. Structural at this premium level. Rule scope needs revision, not the trades.
FR1: Futures flat through events	PASS	No futures exposure through the jobs print.
Mistakes column	LOGGED	Every breach self-flagged with reasoning. Journal quality notably improved.

Two breaches, both worth keeping in view for different reasons. G3 was breached three times with wins each time — the risk is that success writes the rule out by attrition rather than by decision. R9 was breached structurally, which means the rule as written does not fit this strategy and should be re-scoped deliberately. Neither is an execution failure. Both are framework maintenance items.

On journal quality: you flagged last report that reasoning logging had slipped. It has visibly recovered. Every trade this week carries entry time, market read, the reasoning behind the timing decision, and an honest Mistakes entry. Trade 219's note — “ES range-bound, VIX down and dropping — read as favourable” — is exactly the one line that makes a trade analysable months later.

LESSONS LEARNED

WHAT WORKED

- ✓ The template: $0.80 credit, 20-wide, 5 lots, OCO at $0.10. Three consecutive days, three 88% captures, zero discretionary exit decisions.
- ✓ Trade 217's defensive exit: endowment test applied under pressure, position closed, no freeze. The Rule 12 mechanism firing correctly for the second consecutive reporting period.
- ✓ The 217→218 patience: same strikes twenty minutes later at a 23% higher credit. Waiting for structure to confirm paid directly.
- ✓ Trade 220's post-catalyst entry: the binary was resolved before entry. Structurally sound reasoning, correctly documented, and the same logic as the IV crush work.
- ✓ F15's notional observation: recognising 1 ES = 10 MES in real time. The futures risk framing is being internalised.
- ✓ Journal reasoning restored to full quality after last report's flag.

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION

- **1. Don't let three wins retire G3.** The refinement proposed above is a hypothesis on a 3-trade sample in a record-setting bull week. Keep flagging first-hour entries; revisit the rule after 15-20 logged instances including some in adverse tape.
- **2. FR5 (30-minute futures time stop) needs writing up and applying provisionally.** The evidence is suggestive and the mechanism is plausible, but 4 observations above the line is thin. Apply at current size, re-test at 40+ trades.
- **3. Rules 9 and 18 both need re-scoping for wide index spreads.** Both were authored in a single-name context and both now conflict with the core strategy as literally written. Resolve in the framework document so the exceptions are explicit rather than habitual.
- **4. Premium selectivity over size.** Fee drag improves only with higher credit per contract, never with more contracts. A $1.20 entry carries half the proportional drag of a $0.60 entry. This is a quiet argument for patience on entries.

CONCLUSION

+$1,075 gross options, 4 for 4. Futures -$50. Live options cumulative +$2,750 across 65 trades. The strongest options week of the live account, in the strongest market week since April. Those two facts belong in the same sentence.

The template is the real output. Three identical trades, three identical results, exits handled mechanically by OCO with no discretionary decision at the back end. That is what a system looks like when it stops being a series of judgements. The open question is how it performs when the tape is not making records — the June bearish stretch says the answer is "worse, but survivably so, because the stops hold."

The 30-minute line is the finding worth taking away. Every losing dollar in the futures book sits in trades held over half an hour, and the pattern survives removing the FOMC breach. The mechanism is coherent: a scalp held past its edge horizon becomes an unplanned swing trade. It is a small sample and should be treated as a hypothesis — but it is the kind of hypothesis that costs nothing to apply provisionally and could reshape the futures book if it holds.

And the discipline point. Three rule breaches, three wins, all three flagged by you before anyone else saw them. That is the behaviour that makes the journal worth keeping. The framework's most patient enemy has always been outcome bias — a win on a rule break is still a rule break — and the fact that you logged them as breaches rather than as vindication is why this week reads as progress rather than drift.

Next Report: Friday, August 14, 2026
